20453 VENTURE CAPITAL AND VALUATION

Class taught in English

Programs: EMIT (6 crediti - I sem. - OB | 6 cfu - SECS-P/11)

Class: 28 (I sem.)

Department: Finance

Course director: GIMEDE GIGANTE

Class 28

INSTRUCTORS

GIMEDE GIGANTE

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Gimede Gigante is Director of the SDA Bocconi Rome Campus and Director of ICE, Innovation and Corporate Entrepreneurship, the division that leads research, education, and ecosystem building in corporate innovation, startups, and venture capital. He also serves as Director of the European FS Tech Hub in Milan. At Università Bocconi, he is a tenured faculty member in the Department of Finance and serves as Director of the China MiM Double Degree Program in partnership with Fudan University. He is also Academic Director of Bocconi Summer School, which welcomes over 2,000 international students each year. His research focuses on banking, financial innovation, and capital markets. He has held postdoctoral positions at the Stern School of Business, NYU, and Columbia Business School, and has published with Palgrave, Routledge, BUP, and Egea. He is currently Vice President of the Board of Directors of a listed Italian bank and Chairman of the Advisory Board of a leading Italian fintech company. As part of his work in ICE, he regularly collaborates with startups, scaleups, and venture investors across Italy and Europe. He holds a Ph.D. in Banking & Finance, is a Chartered Accountant and Auditor, and has served in advisory roles for both private institutions and public bodies, including the Italian Parliament.

Office hours: in presence, Thursday h:18:00, via Roentgen 1, 2nd floor, room E2-05. Reserve your office hours via YOU@B.

LAURA BOTTAZZI

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Laura Bottazzi is Full Professor of Economics at the University of Bologna. She is a Fellow of (IGIER), Bocconi University, the Center for Economic Policy Research (CEPR), London, an affiliate of AFFECT, the American Finance Association's Committee for Women in Finance, as well as the Committee on the Status of Women in the Economics Profession (CSWEP).

She is an expert in international economics, innovation, venture capital, corporate finance and financial literacy.

She holds a degree in Economic and Social Disciplines from Bocconi University and a Ph.D. in Economics from the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT).

Office hours: September to December 2026, in presence Tuesday h:11.00, via Roentgen 1, 4th floor, D10. Reserve your office hours via email. From January 2027: online upon reservation.

MARTA ZAVA

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Prof. Marta Zava is Assistant Professor of Practice in Finance at SDA Bocconi School of Management, where she also serves as Director of AI Applications to Finance. She holds a Ph.D. awarded with highest honors from Goethe University Frankfurt for a dissertation on venture capital and complex systems, which received multiple international prizes, including those of the French Complex Systems Society and the European Financial Management Association. She serves as an economic expert on venture capital and private capital topics for the Italian Ministry of Economy and Finance, CONSOB, and the European Central Bank, among other leading Italian and European institutions, and has previously worked at the European Commission and at the ECB. She is co-author of the book *The Science of Influencers and Superspreaders* (Springer, 2025), among several other peer reviewed publications and chapters, and her research on venture capital networks, financial markets, and artificial intelligence is published and presented internationally. She is an elected board member of the Complex Systems Society and of the Network Science Society.

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Attention! The program below is to be considered valid ONLY for the academic year 2026/2027.

MISSION

Innovative technology companies are a key driver of growth in advanced economies. They represent the most dynamic segment of entrepreneurial activity and make significant contributions to job creation, higher living standards, and wealth generation. They also play a crucial role in the continued growth of large, established firms, which often acquire start-ups to gain access to new products and technologies.

A central challenge for entrepreneurs is securing resources they do not directly control, particularly financial capital. Investors are critical in this process, as funding not only provides liquidity but also attracts other essential resources such as skilled labor and specialized assets. These investors form the core of the venture capital ecosystem, which has expanded rapidly worldwide over the past decade, fueled by the pursuit of high returns in illiquid markets.

To successfully raise capital, entrepreneurs must develop a clear understanding of the venture capital landscape and the different types of investors within it, such as VC funds, venture capital trusts (VCTs), small business investment companies (SBICs), business angels, incubators, and club deals.

The mission of this course is therefore twofold:

a) to analyze and understand how innovative entrepreneurs secure financing, including financial contracts, company valuation, and the implications for innovation strategy; and
b) to examine the defining characteristics of venture investors, covering legal considerations, taxation issues, and the key aspects of deal-making.

COURSE CONTENT DETAILED - SCHEDULE - EMIT cl.27 & 28

Part One. Venture Capital: Fundamentals, Clusters, Investors

Instructor: Gimede Gigante

1. Course start up: rule of thumbs and general overview
2. The fundamentals of venture capital: definition and main schemes
3. Venture Capital Clusters: seed, start-up, and early stage
4. Venture Capital Investors: Legal framework in Europe for equity investors
5. Venture Capital Investors: Legal framework for Anglo Saxons Countries: US and UK cases
6. Venture Capital Investors: Management Fees and Carried Interest, Risk and Return. Fiscal framework for equity investors: hands-on perspective

Part Two. The Economics of VC and Innovation

Instructor: Laura Bottazzi

7. Financing Innovation: Angel Investors and VCs
8. How do VCs choose and how do they affect firms' decisions
9. The Deal Structure: Contracts and Incentives (I)
10. The Deal Structure (II)
11. The Contract: Dermacare
12. Guest Speaker: a VC

Part Three. The Venture Capital Life Cycle and Valuation

Instructor: Marta Zava

13. VC Trends Outlook 2026
14. Raising a fund and creating a fund thesis
15. Deal sourcing and matching investor and company
16. Venture Capital Networks
17. Due Diligence and Financial Models
18. Investing: Valuation Methods I
19. Investing: Valuation Methods II
20. Portfolio Company Management and Follow-on Investments
21. The end: Exits (M&A)
22. The end: Exits (IPO)
23. Working in VC: Hiring and Interview Process
24. Artificial Intelligence applications in VC

TEACHING METHODS

Selection:

- Lectures
- Guest speaker's talks (in class or in distance)
- Practical Exercises
    - Software-Based Exercises
    - In-class exercises
    - Data Analysis, Graphic Representations/Calculators

The learning experience of this course is mainly based on face-to-face lectures. However, each of the three modules is accompanied by case discussions and presentations by external guest speakers. The use of cases and external speakers aims at better connecting the body of knowledge covered in the course with real life examples, typically focused on complex investment

banking transactions. The interaction between the instructor and students during the case discussions and the presentations helps students understand how professionals in the field approach a transaction and organize it in a structured process going from the deal origination to the final deal execution. Moreover, the usage of softwares help the students to understand the best practices of the financial market as well.

ASSESSMENT METHODS

Selected methods: Continuous assessment	Partial exams	General exam
Written individual exam (traditional/online)	x	x
Open and/or closed answers questions exam	x	x

The final grade is based on a 50%-50% structure for students attending the two partial exams:

• 50%: First mid-term exam covering Parts One and Two (MCQs)
• 50%: Second mid-term exam covering Part Three (MCQs)

Students who opt for the general exam will be required to answer questions covering all three parts of the course.

The exam questions will require students to either discuss specific topics covered during the course or apply the concepts to numerical exercises and mini-cases. The overall objective of the assessment is to evaluate students' ability to collect and organize information and data, and to apply them in solving real-world problems typically faced by venture capital funds, investors, and VC-backed entrepreneurs.

TEACHING MATERIALS - EMIT cl. 28

• Slides and ad hoc readings available in the Bboard Platform.
• Text of case studies available in the Bboard Platform via Bocconi Library's Course Reserves.
• Softwares and exercises available in the Bboard Platform.

HONOR CODE

Bocconi University conceives of education as an ongoing process that stretches across a person's entire professional life. The University hopes that the entire Bocconi community will respect the values of fairness and correctness associated with it, values which inspire and guide the conduct of all community members as they pursue common objectives and a shared mission. Bocconi University is also committed to building a truly inclusive climate based on diversity. With the collaboration of faculty and students, it aims to ensure a safe learning environment free from any form of discrimination based on race, religion, gender, geography, age, disability or sexual orientation, in which there is room for a diversity of approaches and where discussions are always conducted in a respectful manner. The Bocconi University Honor Code is published on the website at http://www.unibocconi.eu/honorcode, we encourage all students to read it.

Updated @ 30/07/2026